

FILM DOSSIER: X-MEN: SECOND GENESIS

Phase 4 · Film #1 (Saga Two, Film #1 · Overall Film #30)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE.  Waiting on the showrunner's real-actor casting picks (see Section 2).

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #1 (Phase 4, Film #1) · MCU #30
Phase	Phase 4 (2021–2024), The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>X-MEN: SECOND GENESIS</i> (the title of Giant-Size X-Men #1's story)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"FIELD TRIP"</i>
Release date	Friday, July 9, 2021 (in theaters and on Disney+ Premier Access the same day)
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Matthew Vaughn (returning from X-Men, 2011)
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + globe-trotting recruitment adventure / creature feature

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The X-Men ensemble. In this film the franchise is led by Hugh Jackman's Wolverine and Tye Sheridan's Cyclops.

Locked cast (returning, or one real actor each)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Logan / Wolverine	Hugh Jackman	52
Professor Charles Xavier	Patrick Stewart	80
Scott Summers / Cyclops	Tye Sheridan	24
Jean Grey / Marvel Girl	Sophie Turner	25
Hank McCoy / Beast	Nicholas Hoult	31
Bobby Drake / Iceman	Shawn Ashmore	41
Warren Worthington III / Angel	Ben Hardy	30
Sean Cassidy / Banshee	Caleb Landry Jones	31
John Proudstar / Thunderbird	Blair Redford	37
Shiro Yoshida / Sunfire	Fresh casting (<i>never played by a real actor</i>)	–
Count Luchino Nefaria	Fresh casting	–
Doctor Doom (<i>post-credit</i>)	Robert Downey Jr.	56
Mephisto (<i>post-credit</i>)	Ciarán Hinds	68

Real-actor cast: ⌚ SHOWRUNNER'S PICKS

On 616 in 1975, the new X-Men are young adults (*Colossus is 19*). **Bold = recommended.****

Character	Options (age at release)	Notes
Ororo Munroe / Storm	Alexandra Shipp (29) · Halle Berry (54)	Shipp is close to Storm's 616 age in 1975
Piotr Rasputin / Colossus	Daniel Cudmore (40) · Stefan Kapičić (voice only, 42)	Cudmore is the only live-action Colossus
Kurt Wagner / Nightcrawler	Kodi Smit-McPhee (25) · Alan Cumming (56)	Smit-McPhee is the right age for the 1975 team

A tribute to Stan Lee, who died in 2018: a Stan Lee mural in the Kenyan village where Storm is found.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Giant-Size X-Men</i> #1 (May 1975), Len Wein & Dave Cockrum, " Second Genesis! ": the original X-Men are captured by Krakoa, the living island , and Xavier recruits a new team from around the world. <i>X-Men</i> #94–95 (1975), Chris Claremont & Dave Cockrum: the original X-Men leave (except Cyclops), and Thunderbird dies stopping Count Nefaria .
Supporting comics	<i>Incredible Hulk</i> #181 (1974, Wolverine) · <i>X-Men</i> #28 (1967, Banshee) · <i>X-Men</i> #64 (1970, Sunfire) · <i>House of X / Powers of X</i> (2019, Hickman): Krakoa , seeded for later
Nerf check	✅ Krakoa beats the entire original team , as in <i>GSX</i> #1. Thunderbird dies holding onto Nefaria's jet , a choice he makes and not a loss written in for drama.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . <i>Giant-Size X-Men</i> #1 is adapted almost panel for panel, with <i>X-Men</i> #94–95 as the final act.

Straight from the page:

- **The original X-Men vanish on the island of Krakoa**. Only **Cyclops** escapes (*GSX* #1).
- **Xavier recruits the new team** from around the world (*GSX* #1):
- **Nightcrawler**, chased by a mob in a **German** village
- **Storm**, worshipped as a **goddess in Kenya**
- **Colossus**, working on a **Soviet collective farm**
- **Sunfire** from **Japan**
- **Thunderbird**, an **Apache** from Arizona
- **Banshee** from **Ireland**
- **Wolverine** from **Canada**
- **Krakoa is a living mutant island that feeds on mutant energy** (*GSX* #1).
- The new team rescues the originals, and **Krakoa is thrown into space** (*GSX* #1).
- **Most of the originals leave. Cyclops stays and leads** (*X-Men* #94).
- **Sunfire walks away**. He doesn't want to be on a team (*X-Men* #94).
- **Count Nefaria takes over NORAD. Thunderbird holds onto Nefaria's jet as it takes off, and dies when it explodes** (*X-Men* #94–95).

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Storm	Weather control (lightning, hurricanes, cold, flight on the wind); Omega-level ; claustrophobic (GSX #1)	A hurricane over Krakoa, lightning strikes, flight	Her top-end planet-scale weather (with bigger threats)	✓ 100%
Colossus	Organic steel form: class-75+ strength , near-invulnerable (GSX #1)	Tears Krakoa's rock apart, catches a falling jet	–	✓ 100%
Nightcrawler	Teleportation (with a <i>BAMF</i> and brimstone smoke); superhuman agility ; blends into shadow; prehensile tail (GSX #1)	Teleporting fight choreography, and taking a whole team through at once	–	✓ 100%
Banshee	Sonic scream : flight, concussive blasts, shattering matter	Screams a hole through Krakoa	–	✓ 100%
Sunfire	Solar plasma : flight, nuclear-level heat	Melts a mountain of Krakoan rock	–	✓ 100%
Thunderbird	Superhuman strength, speed and stamina ; tracker	Punches a tank; the jet	–	✓ 100%
Wolverine	As in <i>Wolverine</i>	Claws, healing, berserker	–	✓ 100%
Cyclops	Optic blasts; a master tactician	Leads the new team	–	✓ 100%
Krakoia	A living mutant island : its whole landmass is a weapon; it drains mutant energy	Beats the original team	–	✓ 100%
Count Nefaria	Criminal mastermind (pre-ionic, 1975)	Takes over NORAD	His later ionic powers (616 later)	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	When his first students disappear on a living island, Charles Xavier goes around the world to recruit a new team of strangers. They have to become the X-Men in one night, or die.
Theme	A second chance. Every new X-Man was an outcast, and together they're a family.
Villain / antagonist	Krakoia (main); Count Nefaria (Act 3)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE LIVING ISLAND

- **Monday, February 15, 2021.** The **original X-Men** go to a mysterious island in the South Pacific to investigate a mutant signal.
- **They disappear.** Only **Cyclops** makes it back, half-dead.
- **Professor X** knows what he has to do: *"I need a new team. Tonight."*

ACT TWO: SECOND GENESIS

- The recruitment montage:
- **Nightcrawler:** a mob with torches in a Bavarian village. *BAMF.*
- **Storm:** worshipped as a goddess in the Kenyan highlands (the Stan Lee mural is in the village).
- **Colossus:** a Russian farm, where he stops a runaway tractor with his chest.
- **Sunfire:** the Tokyo skyline, and he says no until Xavier mentions Krakoa's threat to Japan.
- **Thunderbird:** the Arizona desert. *"Why me?" "Because you're a warrior."*
- **Banshee:** an Irish pub, with a smile.
- **Wolverine:** a Canadian roadhouse (the *Wolverine* post-credit scene, paid off).
- They're strangers, and they fight on the Blackbird on the way there.
- **Krakoa.** The island **comes alive.**

ACT THREE: THE NEW X-MEN

- They save the originals. Storm, Banshee and Sunfire **throw Krakoa into orbit.**
- Back at the Mansion, **the originals step away. Cyclops stays and leads. Sunfire leaves.**
- **Count Nefaria** takes over **NORAD** in Cheyenne Mountain.
- The new team's first mission. Nefaria escapes on a jet. **Thunderbird** grabs on as it takes off and won't let go: *"Not this time."*
- **The jet explodes.** Thunderbird is gone.
- At his grave, Wolverine lights a cigar and says nothing. Storm puts her hand on Cyclops's shoulder: *"We will honor him."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, February 15, 2021 → Saturday, May 22, 2021.
Where it's set	The X-Mansion, Westchester · Krakoa, South Pacific · Bavaria · Kenya · Siberia · Tokyo · Arizona · Ireland · NORAD, Cheyenne Mountain, Colorado (filmed on location on four continents)
Relative to other films	Two years after <i>The Amazing Spider-Man 2</i>. It's the first film of the new saga. The heroes who remember the five lost years are quiet about it.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The All-New, All-Different X-Men. Cyclops leads.**
- **Krakoa**, flung into orbit (and on 616, one day it becomes a **nation**, seeded here).

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Illuminati	Xavier sits alone with a sealed letter marked " I ." He burns it.	The Phase 4 Illuminati
Krakoa in orbit	The last image of the island	Future X-Men films (<i>House of X</i>)

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Two Earths	Cerebro picks up twice as many mutant minds as there should be , and half of them are coming from above . Xavier looks up, afraid.	The first sign of an Incursion
Doom returns	The post-credit scene	The saga's Big Bad is back

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ " BAMF ." Nightcrawler teleports into the Danger Room controls by accident, and the whole team gets blasted with foam. Wolverine: " <i>Elf</i> ."
Post-credit scene	✅ " THE PLATFORM ." Castle Doom, Latveria . Victor von Doom stands before his time platform , which is humming again. On its screens, two Earths hang in space, overlapping . Behind him, a mirror burns . In the flames, Mephisto smiles, holding a woman's hand: Doom's mother, Cynthia . MEPHISTO : " <i>Tick, tock, Victor. Everything dies.</i> " DOOM (not turning): " <i>Not everything. Not while Doom lives.</i> " CUT TO BLACK . " THE X-MEN WILL RETURN ."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " FOAM PARTY ." Post-credit: " HOME MOVIES ."

CHECKLIST

- ☒ Comic(s) adapted · ☒ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☒ Real and decoy titles · ☒ What it's about · ☒ Villain · ☒ Post-credit scenes · ☒ The film's own world-building · ☒ MCU world-building · ☒ Big Bad setup · ☒ Whose franchise · ☒ When and where in the timeline ·  Real-actor casting picks